

L2 - 1.3. Report Writing for SOC L2

Task 1 - Introduction

As you move into a senior (Level 2) analyst role, the scope of your responsibilities shifts. Technical alert triage is still part of the job, but your findings now need to reach people beyond the SOC, through formal case reports.

Task 2 - L1 vs L2 Communication

SOC Level 2 is as much about communication as it is about technical skill. L1 analysts can do an outstanding job triaging alerts, but if those findings aren't communicated clearly, they have no value in the real world. As L2, your job is to turn SOC notes into something actionable: a precise summary report that colleagues, customers, or management can act on. Your report writing skills can decide whether an intrusion is stopped in time. L2 reports must sound credible and professional. Your report is how the outside world sees your SOC.

- **Top management (C-level):** To present an incident summary or a quarterly SOC report
- **External MSSP customers:** To report a detected intrusion and agree on next steps
- **DFIR, CTI, or InfoSec teams:** To hand over the SOC findings and attack indicators



L2 Report Types

- **Case summary for C-level:** A business-focused, non-technical overview of the incident that occurred
- **Email to the MSSP customer:** A formal, actionable summary of what happened and what to do next

- **DFIR team handover notes:** A list of your findings from SIEM/EDR to help the bigger forensics efforts

Communication Channels

Channel	Purpose
Voice Call	Used for urgent situations requiring an immediate response. For accountability, phone or Zoom calls are typically followed up with an email summary.
Email Letter	Security-related updates and incidents should always be communicated via email, with all relevant parties copied (CC) to ensure a clear audit trail.
Ticketing System	Bigger MSSPs have dedicated ticketing systems and customer portals (e.g. Jira ITSM) that are used instead of regular email threads.
Corporate Chat	Ideal for internal and informal discussions. Same as with voice calls, key decisions and incident findings should still be summarized via email.

Answer the questions below

| Which SOC tier, L1 or L2, bridges the SOC and the outside world?

L2

| What do L2 analysts write to summarize SOC findings (one word)?

Reports

Task 3 - Leadership Communication

Reporting to Company Leadership

- **Focus on business:** Focus on what's important for the company, not just SOC.
- **Use formal tone:** Speak and write as an independent expert, not as an old friend.
- **Keep it simple:** Avoid jargon and terminology; your audience is non-technical.
- **Talk in facts:** Keep evidence for your statements (screenshots, snapshots, links).

- **Don't panic:** During incidents, show that the situation is fully under SOC control.

Contacting MSSP Customers

If your SOC operates as an MSSP, you may be communicating with dozens of customers every day. As an L2 analyst, one of the most frequent and important tasks you have is reporting security threats to the customers. This should always be done through an official channel, typically email, with SOC colleagues and customer representatives in copy, so there is a clear and shared record of every communication.

Challenge: Open the website above, review this executive report, and correct what's not right for the target audience by clicking on the highlighted parts. Once you're done, receive the flag for Question 3. For a better experience on small screens, consider opening the website in full-screen mode.

Answer the questions below

| Should you complete the analysis after sharing the initial SOC report? (Yea/Nay)

Yea

| Should you keep your team informed about the ongoing communication?
(Yea/Nay)

Yea

| What flag did you receive after completing the task's challenge?

THM{executive_summary_approved}

Task 4 - SOC/DFIR Communication

SOC and DFIR Relationship: The Digital Forensics and Incident Response (DFIR) team is like a fire department. Whenever a major incident happens, and regular logs aren't enough, they join the efforts and often take the incident ownership over SOC analysts. In smaller companies, SOC and DFIR teams are typically a single entity.

DFIR Handover Notes: Unlike C-level leadership and MSSP customers, DFIR team members focus less on style and language, but more on raw facts and evidence.

They would expect actionable TTPs and attack artifacts from you so that they could start where you ended; one page of your SIEM findings would be more valuable than ten pages of filler text. In our example, TrySaveMe would be interested in:

- **Incident Context:** How everything started and what log sources your SOC monitors
- **Attack Timeline:** When and where the attack started, and how it continued step by step
- **Attack Scope:** All you know about the affected hosts, users, and other related assets
- **Performed Actions:** What response actions have you or the customer already done
- **Raw Indicators:** IPs, domains, hashes, scripts, tools, and other IoCs you identified

Handover Notes Example: Internal notes are often shared on a voice call or through an informal chat channel. However, in our scenario, TrySaveMe is an external DFIR team, so you'd better communicate via email for accountability and legal purposes. Also, keep in mind that DFIR teams rarely need generic recommendations; they are experts and just need the findings and facts.

Challenge: Open the website above, review the handover notes to the DFIR team, and correct any mistakes you find by clicking on the highlighted parts. Once you're done, receive the flag.

Answer the questions below

| Are L2 handover notes meant for a non-technical audience? (Yea/Nay)

Nay

| What part of the handover notes lists your findings chronologically?

Attack Timeline

| What flag did you receive after completing the task's challenge?

THM{trysaveme_would_be_proud}

Task 5 - Responsible AI Usage

You feed your notes and report requirements to a prompt, and receive a well-structured report in the output.

- **Customer profile:** Industry, size, unique MSSP contract agreements
- **Asset details:** Role of the server or position of the affected employee
- **Threat intelligence:** Enriched TI reports about the observed indicators
- **Historical context:** Summaries and outcomes of past similar incidents
- **Monitoring notes:** Interesting False Positives cases or SIEM specifics

Responsible AI Usage: The main pitfalls you can have with using AI-assisted reports are:

- 1. Sensitive Data Exposure:** Never share confidential data or credentials with cloud-based GenAI services.
- 2. Too Much Filler Text:** Keep security reports concise, structured, and focused on actionable findings and recommendations.
- 3. GenAI Hallucinations:** Provide sufficient context and tool documentation to prevent incorrect AI-generated conclusions.
- 4. Destructive Containment:** Carefully validate AI-recommended containment actions to avoid disrupting critical system components.

Answer the questions below

| What should you provide in the AI prompt to get the best reports?

Context

| Should you fully rely on GenAI for critical decision making? (Yea/Nay)

Nay

Task 6 - Conclusion

Communication becomes more critical as you move up to L2 and beyond. Even if you are a security expert, the employees and customers you protect can't act without clear, simple guidance from you. Don't underestimate report writing, as it is a core skill for L2 and further leadership roles.

- Fully investigate the threat first and then start writing the report (no follow-ups)
- Merge the initial and final reports into one complete email for a C-level audience
- Analyse all logs available before sharing handover notes with the DFIR team